United Against Cancer

November 1, 2026





Presented by

WFG | Team ALL IN

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For those fighting, those who survived, and those we lost.

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Cancer by the numbers

What every family in Canada should know

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About 2 in 5 Canadians are expected to be diagnosed with cancer in their lifetime.

In 2026, that's an estimated 254,100 people in Canada, nearly 700 every day.

Sources: Canadian Cancer Society, Cancer statistics (Canadian Cancer Statistics 2025: 42% lifetime probability). 2026 projection: Brenner et al., “Projected estimates of cancer in Canada in 2026”, CMAJ, April 2026.

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Cancer is the leading cause of death in Canada.



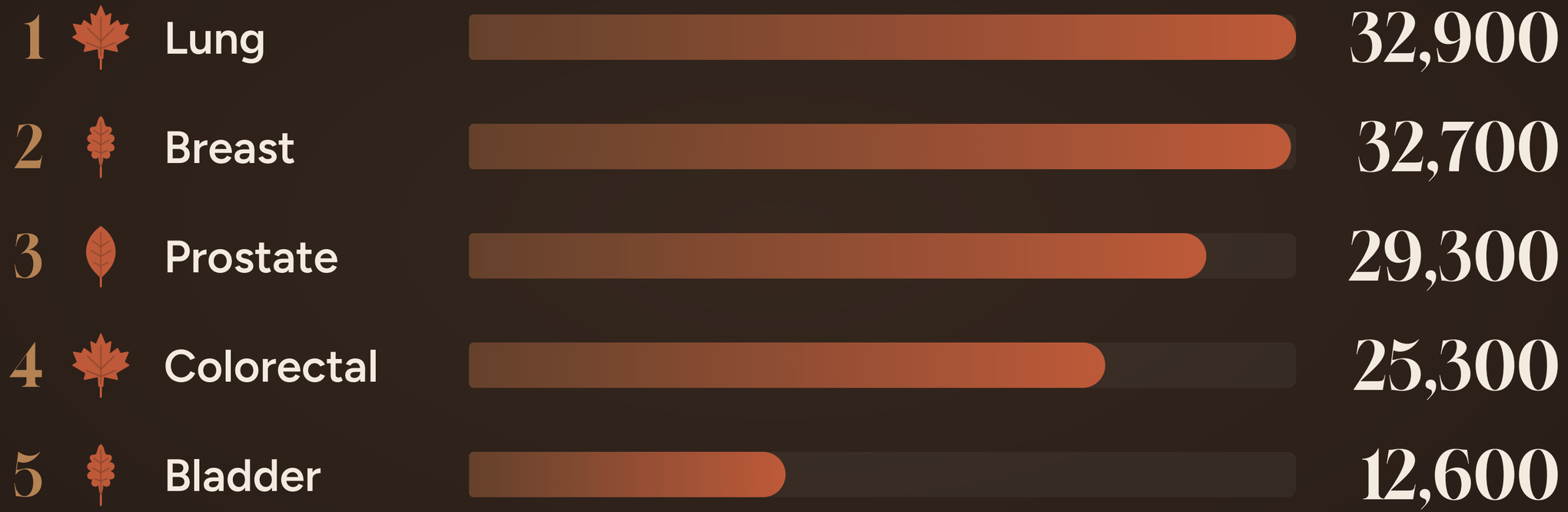
Deaths in Canada, 2023

More than 1 in 5 Canadians (22%) are expected to die from cancer.

Sources: Statistics Canada, Leading causes of death, 2023 (released March 2025). Canadian Cancer Society, Canadian Cancer Statistics 2025 (22% lifetime probability of dying from cancer).

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The five most common cancers in Canada



Estimated new cases each year

The top four alone make up **47%** of all new cancer cases.

Sources: Brenner et al., “Projected estimates of cancer in Canada in 2026”, CMAJ, April 2026 (lung, breast, prostate, colorectal; 47%). Canadian Cancer Society, bladder cancer statistics (2025 estimate).

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Cancer does not discriminate.



Men

1 in 9

will develop prostate cancer in their lifetime.

30,400 men diagnosed in 2025. The second leading cause of cancer death in men.



Women

1 in 8

will develop breast cancer in their lifetime.

About 89 women diagnosed every day, and 15 who die from it.



Children

Up to 1,000

children under 15 are diagnosed every year.

Cancer is the leading cause of disease-related death in children.

Sources: Canadian Cancer Society, prostate cancer statistics (2025 estimates) and breast cancer statistics (2026 estimates). Public Health Agency of Canada, Cancer in Young People in Canada (925 to 1,000 children a year) and childhood cancer trends (leading cause of disease-related death, ages 1–14).

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About

64%

of Canadians survive at least five years after a cancer diagnosis.

So the question isn't only “will I survive?” It's “will my family's finances survive it?”

Source: Canadian Cancer Statistics 2021, Public Health Agency of Canada (about 64% five-year net survival; Canadian Cancer Statistics 2025 reports the same figure).

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Nearly

$33,000

The average cost of cancer to a Canadian patient in out-of-pocket expenses and lost income.

- Prescription drugs
- Home care
- Travel and parking
- Assistive devices
- Family care
- Lost income

Source: Canadian Cancer Society, Canadian Cancer Statistics report, December 2024.

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What Canadians fear

80% Nearly 80% of working-age Canadians worry they'd struggle to save for retirement after a cancer diagnosis.

66% 66% expect they'd have to take significant unpaid time off work.

28% 28% believe they would lose their job.

Source: Canadian Cancer Society and Angus Reid Institute survey, February 2025.

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Cancer is the most common critical illness claim.



69% Cancer

10% Heart attack

4% Stroke

17% All other illnesses

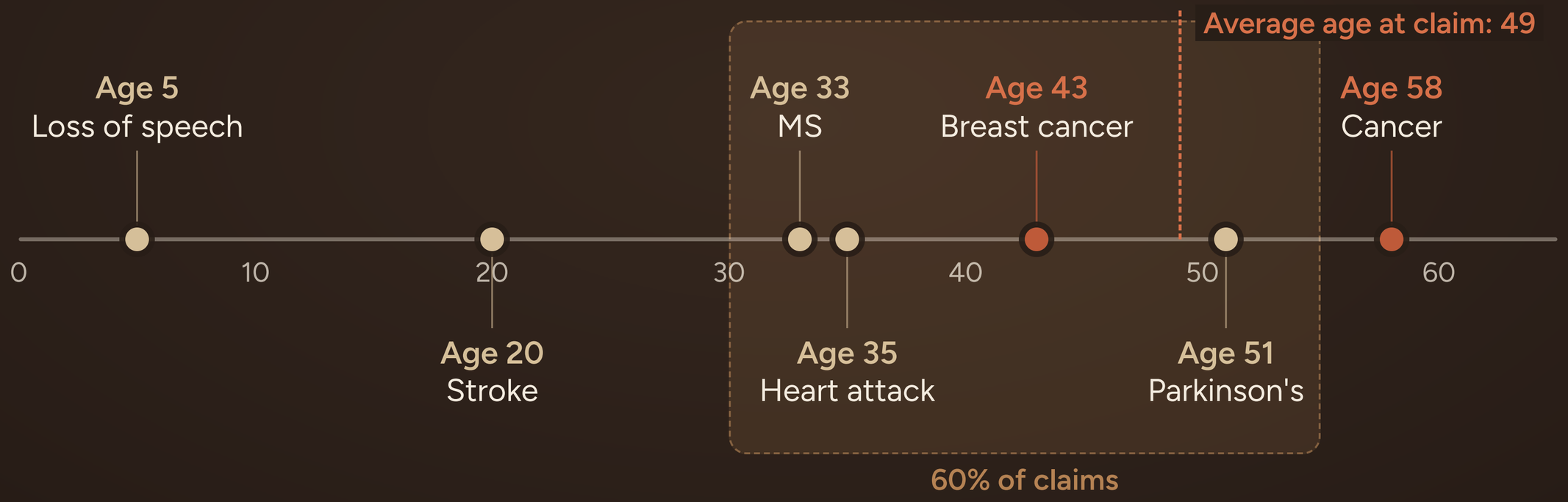
Out of every 100 critical illness claims paid

Source: iA Financial Group, Transition critical illness insurance client guide: distribution of critical illness claims paid (Munich Re individual insurance survey, 2022). “All other illnesses” is the remainder.

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Critical illness can hit anyone, at any age.

Real critical illness claims paid, by age at diagnosis



60% of claims are paid to people between 30 and 55. The average age is just 49.

Source: Equitable, critical illness claims paid January 2013 to December 2025 (example claims, average age at claim, share of claimants aged 30 to 55).

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Critical illness coverage is one essential piece.



- Covers cancer, heart attack and stroke, and many more, from MS to Parkinson's to kidney failure
- Pays you a tax-free lump sum on diagnosis, to spend on anything: the mortgage, treatment, time off
- The average critical illness claim paid: $70,600
- **Not an expense: it protects everything else you're building**

One small piece. Without it, the whole plan can fall apart.

Sources: Equitable, EquiLiving critical illness insurance (26 covered conditions; average claim from claims paid January 2013 to December 2025). iA Financial Group, Transition, and Manulife, Lifecheque (about 25 covered conditions each).

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Foresters Financial

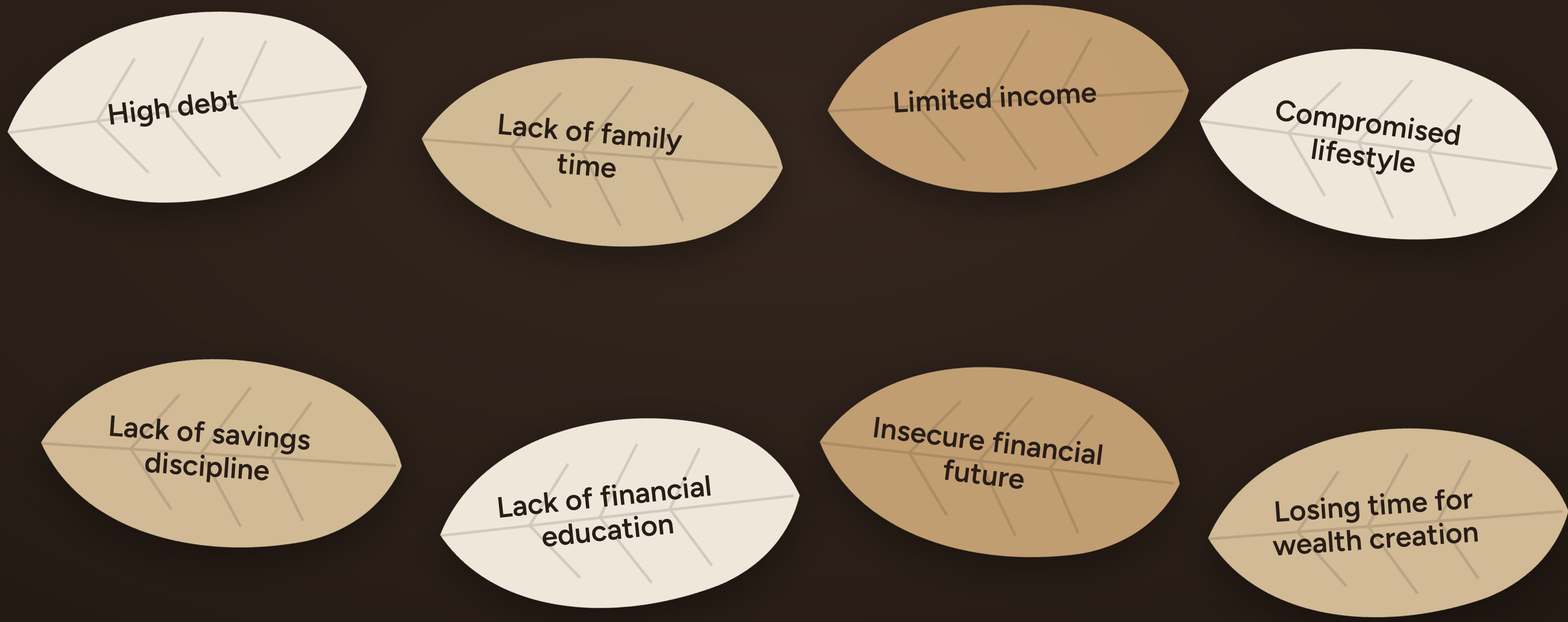
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Do you know exactly what would happen to your income if you couldn't work for six months?

Most families aren't unprepared because they don't care. They're unprepared because everyday life is already a fight.

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The challenges families face every day



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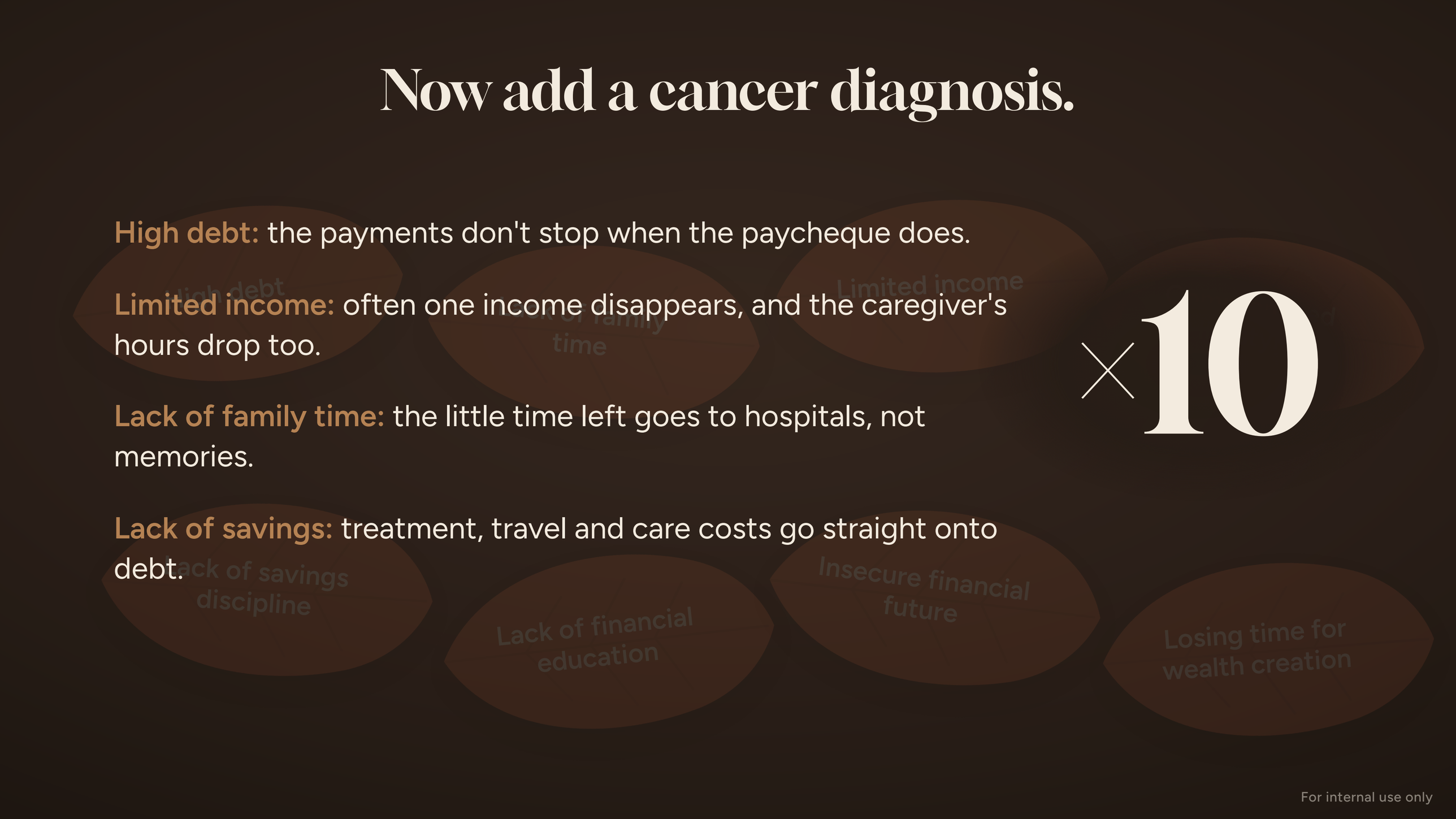
Now add a cancer diagnosis.

High debt: the payments don't stop when the paycheque does.

Limited income: often one income disappears, and the caregiver's hours drop too.

Lack of family time: the little time left goes to hospitals, not memories.

Lack of savings: treatment, travel and care costs go straight onto debt.



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A story from our community

Live

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Same disease. Two different outcomes.

Unprepared

Steven Hodges



- Self-employed, wife and young child
- Stage 4 throat and mouth cancer, 40 rounds of radiation plus chemotherapy
- No disability insurance; his wife's plan didn't fully cover medication
- Lost two years of steady income
- About $125,000 in costs: emptied his RRSPs and TFSAs, took a second mortgage

+ a second mortgage

Family savings — Gone

Prepared

Sandra and Warren



- Married couple with an infant daughter
- Sandra was diagnosed with lymphoma
- They had critical illness insurance
- The coverage let Warren take care of Sandra and their daughter, and eased the financial and emotional strain

Critical illness benefit paid

Family savings — Protected

Steven's story: Canadian Cancer Society, February 2025. Sandra and Warren's story: Canada Life client story.

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I didn't want to let my family down.

Steven Hodges

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Steven had savings. But savings alone couldn't carry two years without income.



Savings habit



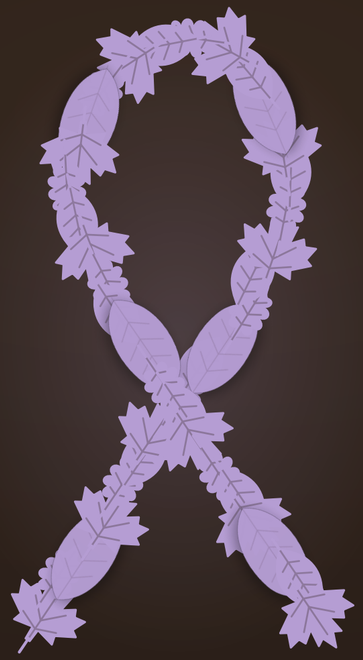
Protection

Build the money. Protect it so a crisis can't take it away. That's a decision you make while you're healthy.

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This is our mission:

No family left behind.



Everyone in this room now knows something most families don't.
That's our shared responsibility.

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So how does a family become the prepared family?



Let's find out.

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